CLASS NOTES · TADABBUR SIRI 1

Surah Al-Fatihah: *Bismillah*

Surah ke-1 · Makkiyyah | The opening of the Quran, and a summary of all of it

IN SHORT

- Al-Fatihah summarises the whole Quran: akidah, ibadah, akhlak.
- Allah introduces Himself through mercy first — Ar-Rahman, Ar-Rahim.
- Nikmat unused (heart, eyes, ears) is what leads people astray.

1. Text & meaning

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

"Dengan nama Allah, Yang Maha Pemurah lagi Maha Penyayang."

WORD BY WORD

1

بِسْمِ	اللَّهِ	الرَّحْمَٰنِ	الرَّحِيمِ
dengan nama	Allah	Yang Maha Pemurah	Yang Maha Penyayang

Dengan nama Allah, Yang Maha Pemurah lagi Maha Penyayang.

2. Al-Fatihah as the summary of the Quran

Everything in Al-Fatihah falls under three big themes:

THEME	MEANING
Akidah	What we believe
Ibadah	How we worship and serve Allah
Akhlak	How we behave

IS BISMILLAH PART OF AL-FATIHAH?

Ulama have two recognised views:

1. Bismillah **is** an ayat of Al-Fatihah; or
2. Bismillah is **not** part of Al-Fatihah, but an ayat revealed as a **separator between surahs**.

This difference affects fiqh, e.g. whether it's read aloud in solat. It's a valid khilaf, not a dispute. In the Kufi count used in the Uthmani mushaf, Bismillah is counted as ayat 1 of Al-Fatihah, so Alhamdulillah *is ayat 2.*

3. "Ilah" — the One who deserves to be worshipped

Ilah (إِلٰه) = the god who truly deserves worship. The question from class: *do we really make Allah the only One we worship?* Because there's another "god" people take without realising — their own desires.

أَفَرَأَيْتَ مَنِ اتَّخَذَ إِلَٰهَهُ هَوَاهُ وَأَضَلَّهُ اللَّهُ عَلَىٰ عِلْمٍ وَخَتَمَ عَلَىٰ سَمْعِهِ وَقَلْبِهِ وَجَعَلَ عَلَىٰ بَصَرِهِ غِشَاوَةً

"Maka pernahkah kamu melihat orang yang menjadikan hawa nafsunya sebagai tuhannya, dan Allah membiarkannya sesat berdasarkan ilmu-Nya, dan Allah mengunci pendengaran dan hatinya, dan meletakkan penutup atas penglihatannya?"

AL-JATHIYAH 45:23

4. Why Ar-Rahman & Ar-Rahim?

Of all His Names, Allah chose to introduce Himself through **two names of mercy**. His rahmat comes before His anger — so that we **know** Him, **love** Him, and **draw closer** to Him.

قُلْ يَا عِبَادِيَ الَّذِينَ أَسْرَفُوا عَلَىٰ أَنفُسِهِمْ لَا تَقْنَطُوا مِن رَّحْمَةِ اللَّهِ ۚ إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَغْفِرُ الذُّنُوبَ جَمِيعًا

"Katakanlah: Wahai hamba-hamba-Ku yang telah melampaui batas terhadap diri sendiri, janganlah kamu berputus asa daripada rahmat Allah. Sesungguhnya Allah mengampunkan dosa-dosa semuanya."

AZ-ZUMAR 39:53

5. Why do so many end up in Hell?

لَهُمْ قُلُوبٌ لَّا يَفْقَهُونَ بِهَا وَلَهُمْ أَعْيُنٌ لَّا يُبْصِرُونَ بِهَا وَلَهُمْ آذَانٌ لَّا يَسْمَعُونَ بِهَا ۚ أُولَٰئِكَ كَالْأَنْعَامِ بَلْ هُمْ أَضَلُّ

"Mereka mempunyai hati tetapi tidak memahami dengannya, mempunyai mata tetapi tidak melihat dengannya, dan mempunyai telinga tetapi tidak mendengar dengannya. Mereka itu seperti binatang ternak, bahkan lebih sesat lagi."

AL-A'RAF 7:179

NIKMAT	NOT USED TO…
Hati (akal)	understand Allah's ayat
Mata	see the signs of His greatness

Telinga	hear His reminders

> Notice the logic: they're condemned not for **lacking** the tools, but for **wasting** the tools they had.

6. Muhasabah: are our nikmat being used well?

Two questions from class:

1. Have Allah's nikmat to us increased since the day we were born?
2. Are we using them to get **closer to Allah** — or the opposite?

Fatir 35:3 — remember Allah's nikmat upon you; is there any creator other than Allah who provides for you from the sky and the earth?

7. Who are the true believers?

إِنَّمَا الْمُؤْمِنُونَ الَّذِينَ إِذَا ذُكِرَ اللَّهُ وَجِلَتْ قُلُوبُهُمْ وَإِذَا تُلِيَتْ عَلَيْهِمْ آيَاتُهُ زَادَتْهُمْ إِيمَانًا وَعَلَىٰ رَبِّهِمْ يَتَوَكَّلُونَ

"Sesungguhnya orang-orang yang beriman itu ialah mereka yang apabila disebut nama Allah, gementarlah hati mereka; apabila dibacakan ayat-ayat-Nya, bertambahlah iman mereka; dan kepada Tuhan mereka sahaja mereka bertawakkal."

AL-ANFAL 8:2

How do we know iman has increased? Not by feelings alone — by **more amal soleh**. Examples from class:

- Used to read one page of Quran a day → now reading more each day.
- Used to do only the fardu prayers → now adding the sunat rawatib.

THE 12 RAKAAT RAWATIB

مَنْ صَلَّى اثْنَتَيْ عَشْرَةَ رَكْعَةً فِي يَوْمٍ وَلَيْلَةٍ بُنِيَ لَهُ بِهِنَّ بَيْتٌ فِي الْجَنَّةِ

"Sesiapa yang solat dua belas rakaat dalam sehari semalam, akan dibinakan untuknya sebuah rumah di syurga."

MUSLIM 728 (UMMU HABIBAH) · SAHIH

TIME	RAKAAT
Sebelum Subuh	2
Sebelum Zuhur	4
Selepas Zuhur	2
Selepas Maghrib	2

Selepas Isyak	2

8. Closing reminder

Az-Zumar 39:47 — on the Day of Judgement, people will see from Allah what they **never expected**. Even if the wrongdoers owned everything on earth and as much again, they would offer it all to ransom themselves.

Reflection

- **Nikmat up, amal up?** The class's muhasabah question can actually be checked. If our income has grown over the years, has our sedekah grown with it — or only our spending? Compare what we give against what we earn, not just the amount.

Personal notes from the Tadabbur class (Siri 1), compiled for revision and sharing. All ayat and hadith checked against quran.com, sunnah.com and dorar.net. Any mistakes are mine — please tegur. والله أعلم